

Victory Over Sin and Temptation

This lesson is the eighth in the series entitled “The Beginner’s Bible Study.” Other lessons in this series can be obtained through the Lehigh Valley Baptist Church.

The lessons are designed to be first studied, then the questions in the back answered, and then reviewed with the help of an older Christian.

*“As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus
the Lord, so walk ye in Him.”*

Colossians 2:6

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In the previous lessons, we have been dealing with lessons that will be helpful to young converts—those who have just received Christ as Savior. This lesson will be addressing how to handle temptation, which is really the onslaught of the devil and how to get victory in your Christian life.

We dealt in the last lesson with confession of sin. The fact is that every one of us who are born again children of God can and will sin. Some people are under the misunderstanding that somehow, when they become a Christian, they will never again sin. But that is not Bible teaching. The Bible teaches that we will sin, and we do sin. Yet God has provided a way of victory for us, a way to overcome sin in our lives so we do not need to fall prey to the devil's traps which he lays for our lives.

James 1:13 tells us, *“Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man. But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.”* Some Christians make excuses for the reason they sin. They like to say, “Everybody has their downfall, everybody has their sin, and this one happens to be mine.” For the child of God, there is no excuse for us to give up on any sin in our life and to be willing to say, “I am just going to live with it.”

In John 10:10, the Bible says that Jesus told the disciples, *“I am come that they might have life, and that they may have it more abundantly.”* It is the Lord's desire that we, as Christians, have an abundant kind of Christian life. A life that is overflowing, a life He talks about in John 7 as being one that has the rivers of waters gushing out. In other words we are filled with the Spirit of God and the Lord is in charge of our lives. That is God's desire for our lives.

THE REALITY OF TEMPTATION

Regarding the subject of temptation, there are four areas that I want to discuss. First of all, let's look at the reality of temptation. The Bible tells us in James 1:13, *"Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil."*

In I John 1 we see several interesting verses. In verse 8, John says, *"If we say that we have no sin (singular), we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us. If we confess our sins (plural), he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins (plural), and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."* Then He says in verse 10, *"If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us."*

The Bible teaches that the man who says, "I have had no sin (singular) in my life," is one who does not have the truth. This is a person who has not received Jesus Christ as his personal Savior. Every person who is a saved child of God would freely admit there was a time in his life when he did not know the Lord Jesus Christ. Any person who says, "I have always known God, I have always been a Christian," you can mark it down, that person has never been born again. They have never known the grace of God. The child of God knows there was a time when they were condemned.

In verse 10, God tells us that if any man says he has not sinned and he has never committed any individual acts of sin, he makes God a liar and the Word of God is not in him. The Lord is telling us that as Christians we can—and we do—sin. No Christian who is honest and will tell the truth will ever say to you, "I don't sin anymore. I have reached a state of perfection." We still have the old nature living inside of us, and sometimes we listen to it instead of it God.

Each of us do sin. That is a sad reality, but it is true. The Bible teaches four truths in I Corinthians 10 about the temptation and sin that comes in our lives. You have probably heard the analogy, “You cannot stop the birds from flying over your head, but you can stop them from building a nest in your hair.” I am glad that is true. The Bible says in I Corinthians 10:13, *“There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.”*

What we have introduced so far is this: The Bible teaches that we do sin, we have sinned, and we will sin. We cannot get away from that fact, we cannot deny that fact unless we want to call God, and God’s Word, a lie. We are sinners. Yet, there is another side to the coin found in I Corinthians 10:13. There are four things about sin and temptation in our lives that we will look at.

Temptation is Common

Number one, temptation is common in your life and in my life. It is common to man. Sometimes we have the idea that when we hit a temptation, we recognize a problem, or we notice an area of weakness in our life, that nobody has ever faced this kind of a trouble before. We think nobody understands the problem we are facing, nobody understands how hard the temptation is that we must handle.

I have heard the fellows out in the world on a job where the pressure is intense and the opportunities for sin are numerous. Everywhere they turn is just another opportunity to sin. They shake their heads and say, “If anybody else had to face this, they would fall, too!” And

they try to excuse their sin that way. But the Bible says very clearly here that you and I will never face any kind of a temptation that is uncommon. It is a common temptation. Jesus knows all about it. He has faced temptation. He never fell into sin, but He did face temptation.

Other Christians know, maybe not the circumstances you are in, but they know the bottom line cause for that temptation. And other Christians have gone through pressures and problems just like you and I. The Bible says temptation is common to every man. So there are other Christians who have faced the same kinds of temptations that you and I have.

Temptation is Limited

It says in verse 13, *“But God is faithful who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able.”* God has put into every one of our lives a “buffer zone.” He has put into our lives a limiting factor, a “buffer” where temptation can only go so far, and it must stop. It is interesting that God has designed that place where He has drawn the line for my life in a different place than He has drawn the line in your life. That is because God knows exactly what you can handle. He knows exactly what I can handle. He knows what is too much and He knows how much is enough in our life.

God has literally drawn the line. We see this truth in the life of Job in the Old Testament. Satan came along and said to God, “Job fears you because you are taking care of him. That is the only reason he serves you.” And God said, “No, it is because he loves Me and he cares about Me.” Then Satan said, “If you will take your hand off him, take the hedge out from around him and let me have a free-for-all with him, I will be able to get him to fall.” God said, “Here is

what you can do to him. You can do take anything you want from him, but you may not take his life!” And God set limits on what Satan could do to Job.

That is exactly what He does in your life and in mine. God has set limits in our lives and we ought to take comfort in the fact that we will never face a temptation that is too strong for us to be able to handle. If you fall into sin, it is not because the temptation is too strong. It is because you did not take advantage of the ways of escaping that temptation that God has given us.

Temptation is Escapable

Number one, temptation is common. Others have faced the same temptation you and I face. Number two, temptation is limited. You will never face a temptation that is more than we can bear. Number three, temptation is escapable. The verse says, *“God is faithful who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape...”*

Not escape into the temptation, but escape away from the temptation. God, in every one of our temptations and weaknesses has built a door for us to get out. He has made a way for us to escape, a way for us to be able to take the temptation and close the door and say, “Absolutely, no!” When we choose to sin it is because we will not take the door of escape that Jesus Christ has already provided.

Temptation is Bearable

The fourth lesson here in this passage is that temptation is bearable. He says, *“...that ye may be able to bear it.”* In other words, whatever problem you may be going through, not only does God have a way of escape, but God has a way that you can hold up under

the pressure and hold up under the hard times. Whether those hard times may be some kind of sorrow, or financial pressure, or a moral temptation, or whatever else it may be, God has made not only a way to escape, but a way for us to be able to bear whatever the temptation may be in our lives.

Now that, my friend, is the reality of temptation. The world has different ways of looking at it. What the world will do when you fall into sin is say, “What you need to do is redefine what is right and wrong. What you did that you think was wrong, include that on your list of rights and explain it away, then you haven’t done anything wrong.” The problem is, you can never erase the guilt, because if it is sin in the eyes of God. The only way it will ever be taken away is by the blood of the Lord Jesus Christ.

THE RESULTS OF TEMPTATION

Not only do we need to talk about the reality of this temptation, but secondly we also need to talk about the results of the temptation and ultimately the sin we commit. The results could be summed up in one word. That word is **DEATH**.

In Proverbs 9:17 the Bible says, “*Stolen waters are sweet, and bread eaten in secret is pleasant.*” Isn’t that exactly what sin is? Sin is always enticing. Sin is always pleasant- looking. Sin always seems to taste sweet. Verse 18 closes it out and says, “*But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell.*” God says that although sin may look pleasant and taste sweet, sin will always lead to the pits of hell. Sin will always lead to death. Sin will always lead to misery and destruction. That is the end result of sin.

We read in I Corinthians 6:9, *“Know ye not that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? Be not deceived: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind, nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God.”* Sin brings about death.

In Revelation 21:8 the Bible says, *“But the fearful, and unbelieving, and the abominable, and murderers, and whoremongers, and sorcerers, and idolaters, and all liars, shall have their part in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone: which is the second death.”* The Bible talks about death being the end result of sin. It is not talking about the death that leads to the grave, though the death that goes to the grave was brought about by man’s sin. But that is not where life ends. You will not come to some place in your life where all of a sudden it all ends and you get swallowed up by the dirt and that is where everything is finished for you. There is no such thing as a class of people who go to the grave and sleep.

The Bible teaches that when a man dies in his sins, he lifts up his eyes in torments. He winds up in a place called Hell. There is a literal Hell. When a man dies outside of Jesus Christ, he goes directly to Hell. He does not spend any time in a grave. If a man knows Jesus Christ, however, he has eternal life and he goes directly to be with the Lord Jesus Christ.

THE ROUTES OF TEMPTATION

I want to talk to you now about the routes of temptation, or how we get temptation in our life. I think it is important that we know we are going to face temptation and know God has made a way to escape. But if we succumb to it, it ought to make us say, “I want out!” The

best way for me to get out of temptation and stay away from falling into temptation and into sin, is to figure out how I am going to be tempted.

I am going to lay out for you very clearly and very simply what God says the three routes temptation will take. All three are found in I John 2:15-17. The Bible says, *“Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world. If any man love the world, the love of the Father is not in him. For all that is in the world, the lust of the flesh, and the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life, is not of the Father, but is of the world. And the world passeth away, and the lust thereof: but he that doeth the will of God abideth for ever.”*

The way that sin will always come to you will be: number one, THROUGH THE WORLD, number two, THROUGH THE FLESH, and number three, THROUGH SATAN. Most folks would probably invert the order and put it the other way around and put Satan first. But that is not the case. The way Satan normally works in our lives will be through the world and through ourselves and then, finally, through himself. Satan does not like to be exposed. He does not like to do his work out in the open. He likes to keep it quiet. He likes to do it behind closed doors. He likes to do it in darkness and in blackness so folks don't know he is even involved. That is how Satan likes to work. Let's look at these three areas.

The World

When we talk about the world, what we are talking about here is not the physical world we reside upon—not planet Earth. But we are talking about the system of this world that we live in and the way in which it is run. We are talking about the selfish principles this world is governed by. We are talking about the improper motives people

have for doing the things they do. We are talking about ungodly standards the world sets for right and wrong. We are talking about the world's way of running things—that's the system we find ourselves in.

The sad part is that most Christians, probably every one of us, are influenced by the world in which we live. We set our standards, judge our motives and put our lives together by the standard of the world, instead of by God's standard. Many times I have talked to a person about their Christian life and what is right and what is wrong, and they are quick to argue and say, "But preacher, I just don't agree. I think..." and that is exactly where their problem is. They are thinking instead of letting God do the thinking. They are not letting God tell them what is right and what is wrong.

The Word of God is very clear on what is right and what is wrong, yet you and I have wrong motives. Let me illustrate that for a moment. Why do you husbands treat your wives as you ought to? In most cases, husbands treat their wives right so their wives would then treat them right. That is not the Biblical reason. Yet many times have I talked to different couples and the husband says, "If she would treat me right, I would be sweet to her." That is the wrong reason. God says you are supposed to love her even if she is the meanest witch you have ever known. You are still supposed to love her.

God's Word is very clear. Your motives need to be because you love the Lord Jesus Christ and that is why you do what you do. All of us, to some degree in our lives, are governed by selfish motives. "I want what I want, and if I get what I want, I will do what is right. And if I don't get what I want, I am going to take a second thought about whether I am going to obey God."

Not only could we be talking about improper motives and selfish principles, we could be talking about ungodly standards. It is amazing how Christians set their standards by how the world is today. You see, Christians set their standards by being just a little more conservative than what the rest of the world is doing. Then they believe their standards will be okay. Our standards ought not to change through the ages. Our standards still ought to be the same if we are following the same Word of God that God gave us to begin with.

The Flesh

Not only are we tempted by the world, but also by the flesh. In James 1:14 the Bible says, “*But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.*” Do you realize the reason you sin is not because, as Flip Wilson says, “The devil made me do it”? It is not because of him. In most cases we do not need the devil to trip us up. We do quite a good job without him even bothering in our lives.

Our problem is not the world we live in. Some people say, “Let’s get away from this world.” Some Christians devised, in years gone by, a system of becoming a kind of hermit and living out in caves and sand dunes, finding a place far away from everyone. If they could shut themselves off from the world and all that terrible wickedness that’s out there, they could become Godly people! The only problem was they had to take themselves along. They found out they had to live with themselves and their sin did not come from the world, their sin came from themselves.

We are influenced by the world, but James said the reason you and I choose to sin is because of our own sinful desires. Our own lusts

work within our members. Our own desires operate within our lives. **The reason you sin is because you choose to sin.** Nobody made you do it. It is not your husband's fault. It is not your wife's fault. It's not your boss's fault. It's not the world's fault. It is your fault if you choose to sin. You and you alone.

We could say, "Amen" to that, but the fact is, most of us still find excuses for why we sin when we sin. We like to blame it on someone else.

The Devil

Third of all, there is the devil. Let's not underestimate him. The Bible says in I Peter 5:8, *"Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour."* Satan is alive on planet Earth. He is real. He is not some figment of someone's imagination. He is not a cartoon character. He is a real individual who is after your life and my life, and he realizes, if you are a Christian, he cannot take you to Hell.

You cannot lose your salvation if you are a child of God. But there is something the devil is after in our lives, if you are a Christian, and that is your testimony. Because he realizes if you have a Godly testimony, you can be of effect in winning other people to Jesus Christ. If he can stop that testimony from going out, Satan has you where he wants you and he keeps other people where he wants them.

We need to be aware that Satan is alive, and he is real. He is a liar and he will lie to you. He will tell you the things of the world are what you really want. He will tell you sin is sweet, and sin is pleasant. He will tell you that it will give you what you want. He

will lie to you. But as soon as you take the bait, as soon as you bite into that sweet morsel of sin, you will find a hook underneath.

You will then find Satan becoming the accuser of the brethren. He will get you to fall into sin by putting his arm around you, enticing you along saying, “Come on, it will be alright, it’s really not bad, you will enjoy it!” The moment you fall into the sin, he leaves your side and goes directly to God and says, “Did you see what that fellow down there just did? Did you see how wicked and terrible he is? He is a rotten kind of a Christian!” Satan likes to accuse us. That is his self-made job.

You mark it down. You are going to be tempted by Satan. He is going to bring things into your life to try to get you off track. The world you live in is going to try to entice you into sin. Don’t listen to the counsel of the ungodly. Don’t set your standards by the world’s standards. Look to God’s Word for that.

But, ultimately the thing you and I wrestle with, the avenue through which sin and temptation comes to us the strongest is not the world system in which we live. The strongest avenue is not the devil running around. The strongest avenue is our own sinful desires, our sinful old flesh that we must contend with every day of life. That is where we fight our greatest battle.

THE REMEDY FOR TEMPTATION

Then I want to talk to you about the remedy for temptation. There are six things about how to deal with the matter of temptation in your life. Every one of you will be tempted, every one of us are. The results of that temptation, if you fall into sin will be death and destruction. It will be something that will destroy your life.

Close the Door to Satan

God is not willing that you fall into sin. God does not desire that at all. The fact is there are some avenues in your life that Satan is going to work in. What you need to do is shut yourself off from Satan. You need to close the door to some areas in your life.

Don't open yourself up to drugs or alcohol and any kind of fortune telling and cards. Stay away from cards. I don't care what kind of a deck it is, it is not of God, stay away from it. Ouija boards are bad. Some folks have gotten involved with them and thought it was just a fun game and Satan got an advantage in their life and came in. Stay away from those things. Stay away from your horoscopes in the paper. Those are things God condemns, and they are an abomination to Him. You need to close the door to Satan in your life in those areas.

Close the Door to the World

Number two, you need to close the door to the world in your life. There are things in this world that certainly we cannot totally close our lives from. We cannot become hermits and live out in the desert somewhere because that is not God's intention. But neither do you have to pipe the world right smack into your living room. Neither do you have to dress like and live like and look like and talk like the world. You don't have to do that. But if you choose to do that you can mark this down. You are bringing yourself to a point of temptation where you are going to fall.

Close the Door to the Flesh

The third area you have to close the door on is the flesh. You cannot totally get rid of this flesh, and you are always going to have it. But

you need to deal with it. Every one of us has certain areas of weakness in our lives. You have weaknesses that are peculiar to you—areas of weakness that you need to guard against and you need to close the door on, finally and completely in your life. Those may not be areas of weakness another person has real bouts with, but you need to close the door no matter what anyone else does if it is an area of temptation into which you may fall.

How do we overcome temptation when it is going to come, and when we are still going to face some temptation, how do we stop it? In Revelation chapter 21 the Bible talks about the tribulation saints who were facing the antichrist and how they overcame him. The antichrist is Satan in the flesh during this seven years of tribulation.

Right here and now we are dealing with the antichrist, spiritually speaking. We are dealing with Satan himself. How are we going to overcome him in our life? **Number one, you need a relationship with Jesus Christ.** Unless you have a relationship to the Lord Jesus Christ there is absolutely no way you will ever be able to overcome temptation in your life. The Bible teaches in John 8 that you are bound in your sin, your sin holds you, binds you, chains you to that sin. Though you may desire to be broken free and set free from whatever sin it is that holds you, you will never be able to come free of that sin, if you are still lost.

Immediately someone will say, “Preacher, I knew somebody who was an alcoholic and they didn’t get saved, but they got free from their drinking!” That’s right, they got free from their drinking and they got chained by a worse sin than that, the sin of pride. They think now they don’t need Jesus Christ. I am saying to you, if you set yourself free from one sin, you will be bound by another sin. The only person that can be set free is the one who knows Jesus Christ

as their personal Savior. *“Ye shall know the truth, Jesus said, and the truth shall make you free.”* The truth is Jesus Christ. So, first of all, you must have a relationship with Jesus Christ.

Number two, you must be controlled by the Holy Spirit. Revelation chapter 12 and verse 11, *“And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death.”* These believers were sold out completely and totally to Jesus Christ. Another way of putting it is they submitted themselves to the Holy Spirit of God. They were filled with the Spirit. They would not allow themselves to be controlled by a selfish spirit. They would not allow themselves to be controlled by others. They wanted to be controlled by Christ, and Christ alone. You will never find victory over temptation in your life as long as you lead a selfish Christian life doing the things you want to do instead of the things God wants you to do. This is really where the battle is.

In talking to folks in counseling and dealing with folks who have problems in their lives, I have found the strongest and hardest hurdle every one has to get over is this hurdle of submitting one hundred percent to Jesus Christ. When you submit, then you can begin to put into effect the remedies and the outworkings of the Word of God in your life and you will find victory for your sin. But until you are willing to submit to Christ, forget it! We could talk about Romans 13:14, *“...make not provision for the flesh.”* We could talk about Galatians 5:16 and Ephesians 5:18 that tell us we must be filled with the Spirit of God and walk in the Spirit.

Number three, we need to rest in the work of Christ. Notice again what the Bible said there in verse 11, *“...they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb.”* It was the blood of the Lamb that overcame the

devil. It was the work that Jesus Christ had accomplished. The Bible says in the book of I John 5:4-5, *“For whatsoever is born of God overcometh the world: and this is the victory that overcometh the world, even our faith. Who is he that overcometh the world, but he that believeth that Jesus is the Son of God?”*

We are not set free because of what we do. We are not set free because we have taken some kind of a special course and now we know the answers. We are not set free because we sit in church and taken notes on a piece of paper. That is not how you get set free from sin. Some of you are tempted to go out to a bookstore and buy a tape offered on your television set that says if you will just listen to it, a subliminal message will hypnotize you to stop smoking, but it won't work. I am telling you, that is not the answer God has.

God's answer is that you realize the only thing that can set you free from your sins is the work of Jesus Christ on Calvary. When He died on the cross and paid for your sins, His blood set you free (Hebrews 2:14) and destroyed the power of Satan in your life. Satan does not have any claim on any Christian, and does not have any right to enforce on them a subjection to sin. If you sin, it's because you choose to sin. It's not because you have to sin.

You may say, “I'm not a Christian.” Then, you don't have any choice, you are going to sin. But if you are a Christian, you have no excuse whatsoever for your sin except for your own selfishness. “This is what I want to do!”

Saturate Your Mind with the Bible.

Then, number four, let's look in II Corinthians 10. This truth I could not overemphasize even if I tried. In verse 5 the Bible is talking

about the war we are in and it says, *“Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ.”*

The Lord Jesus Christ, when He faced the devil in Matthew 4, quoted the Word of God three times. Satan came to Him and said, “What about...?” and Jesus said, “It is written...” And Satan left Him for a season. The Bible teaches that we must saturate our minds with the Word of God. Then we will be able to resist the temptations the devil brings our way.

We must cast down imaginations of the heart. The imaginations that come because of a false thinking and of a world system that we have been educated with. We need to re-think the positions we stand on. We need to re-think what is right and what is wrong in our lives. And we need to re-think them, not according to our great mental faculty, but according to the written Word of God. What does God say? We need to submit our thinking to the Bible. We need to saturate our minds and our hearts with the Word of God.

There have been many times when I have been tempted to sin that the Lord has brought some thought back to my remembrance. He did not bring back some great sermon some preacher preached, or some ideas some Christian passed on to me. Instead He brought back the Word of God I had written on the table of my heart through memorization and meditation as God had spoken to my heart in daily quiet time with Him. God would call back to memory a verse of Scripture that would deal with a particular need in my life at the right time and season.

I am saying to you, the Bible is important. If you are asking, “How do I overcome sin?” I will say to you, “You never will if you do not get in the habit of spending time with God every single day in your life.” There will be no victory for you apart from that. There are no quick fixes, and there are no pills. The Word of God is the only thing that is quick and powerful and able to do the job in your life or mine.

Resist the Devil

Then, we are to resist the devil as we are told in I Peter 5:9, “*Whom resist stedfast in the faith.*” We are told to resist the devil. James 4:7 says, “*Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.*” The way you resist the devil is the same way Jesus Christ did. You resist him by quoting the Word of God.

Could I suggest to you that you memorize the Bible—not just read it? Then you can quote it out loud to the devil if you get into a place of temptation. There is just something about speaking the Word of God as opposed to just thinking about it. I am not against thinking about it. If you are in the wrong kind of place, you may not be able to speak it out loud. But nine times out of ten, you will be somewhere that you can quote the Word of God. If you quote the Word of God you will find that it will have more impact in your life.

In fact, one interesting thing, when having your devotions and you find they are starting to get dry, try getting somewhere in a quiet place where you can be alone and read the Bible out loud to yourself. See what it does in your life. You will find that it will have an impact being read out loud.

Watch and Pray

Then, last of all, let's look at Mark 14:38. "*Watch ye and pray, lest ye enter into temptation. The spirit truly is ready, but the flesh is weak.*" We need to watch and pray. We have got to stay on guard. There is no way you and I can overcome temptation in our lives if we are going to take a vacation in this matter of watching out for sin. We need to keep our eyes open and be on guard because Satan is a roaring lion that is walking about seeking whom he may devour. Even now, he is looking for a way to get into your life.

The time he is going to get after you is probably not the time when you are at your very lowest. Because when you are at your lowest, that is when you are watching the most. When did Satan come to Christ and give Him his greatest temptation? His greatest temptation came right after the baptism. He had been baptized, and He went off into the wilderness and the Bible says Satan came to Him and tempted Him in the wilderness. That is how Satan works in your life and in mine. After great victories, look out, because the greatest temptations are always going to come at that time.

CONCLUSION

What I am saying to you is this—temptation can be overcome. Temptation is not sin in itself. Every man is tempted, but when you are tempted, what you do with it is your choice. If you are wise, you will resist the temptation, find God's way of escape, and flee from it. If you choose to give in to the temptation, you have sinned against a Holy God. But if you choose to give in, it is you that chose to give in. No one made you do it. If you are a child of God, it is not God's will.

I encourage you, if you do not know Jesus Christ, come to know Him! You must be saved. That is the only way to be set free from sin. Number two, I encourage you, if you are a Christian, to begin to live like one, and determine you are going to spend time in the Bible and let the Bible begin to live inside of you.

QUESTIONS ON VICTORY OVER SIN & TEMPTATION

1. What kind of a life does the Lord want us to have? (John 10:10)

2. Is there any unusual temptation? (I Corinthians 10:13)

3. Temptation is unlimited.
Circle One: TRUE or FALSE

4. Death is the end result of _____.

5. What three routes will sin take in approaching the believer?
 - a.
 - b.
 - c.

6. The devil is described as an adversary and as a _____
_____ in I Peter 5:8.

7. What three ways did the believers in Revelation 12:11 use to be overcomers?
 - a.
 - b.
 - c.

8. Who can overcome the world in I John 5:4-5?

9. How did Jesus overcome temptation as seen in Matthew 4:1-11?

10. James 4:7 tells us what Satan will do if we resist him. How will he react?